GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

Ministry of Commerce & Industry

Driving India's Global Economic Leadership

Confidential and Proprietory
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SHRI NARENDRA MODI

HONORABLE PRIME MINISTER, INDIA



MESSAGE

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SHRI PIYUSH GOYAL



HONORABLE MINISTER,
MINISTRY OF COMMERCE AND INDUSTRY

MESSAGE

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DIRECTOR GENERAL, CHAMBER OF COMMERCE AND INDUSTRIES OF INDIA

MESSAGE

India's emergence as one of the world's fastest-growing major economies is underpinned by a dynamic trade and industrial ecosystem that fosters innovation, entrepreneurship, manufacturing excellence, and global competitiveness. The Ministry of Commerce and Industry plays a pivotal role in driving industrial growth, promoting exports, facilitating investments, strengthening intellectual property systems, supporting startups, and creating an enabling business environment that accelerates economic transformation.

The Chamber of Commerce and Industries of India (CCI India) remains committed to partnering with the Ministry in advancing India's vision of becoming a global manufacturing and trading powerhouse.

This Knowledge Paper provides comprehensive insights into the Ministry's policy framework, flagship initiatives, industrial and trade reforms, investment opportunities, global market trends, and emerging sectors driving India's economic future. It also identifies strategic opportunities where CCI India can support industrial clusters, startup ecosystems, supply chain resilience, digital commerce, export diversification, research commercialization, and public-private collaboration.

Designed as a strategic reference for policymakers, government agencies, industry leaders, investors, entrepreneurs, exporters, academic institutions, and development organizations, the publication seeks to facilitate informed decision-making and collaborative action.

As India progresses towards the vision of **Viksit Bharat 2047**, the Ministry's role in shaping a resilient and globally integrated economy will remain increasingly significant. CCI India looks forward to strengthening its collaboration with the Ministry of Commerce and Industry in creating an inclusive, competitive, and innovation-driven economic ecosystem that contributes to national prosperity.

Munindra Kumar
Director General
CCI India

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PREFACE

India stands at a decisive juncture in its economic trajectory. As the world's fifth-largest economy and the fastest-growing major economy, India's ambition to become a Viksit Bharat a fully developed nation by 2047 rests critically on the twin pillars of robust commerce and competitive industry. At the centre of this transformation stands the Ministry of Commerce and Industry (MoCI), the apex institution responsible for shaping India's trade architecture, industrial policy, investment ecosystem, and startup innovation landscape.

This Knowledge Paper has been prepared by CCI India the Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India as a strategic advisory document intended to illuminate the Ministry's evolving mandate, map the landscape of opportunities, and articulate a structured framework for meaningful public-private collaboration. The paper draws on publicly available data, policy documents, Budget allocations, international benchmarks, and sector-level analyses to present a comprehensive, consulting-grade assessment of India's commerce and industry ecosystem.

The Ministry of Commerce and Industry holds a unique constitutional and institutional position: it is simultaneously a trade negotiator on the global stage, an industrial policy architect domestically, an investment promotion catalyst, and an innovation enabler through its stewardship of the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) and the India Brand Equity Foundation (IBEF). Few ministries carry the breadth of economic responsibility that MoCI does, making strategic engagement with it a high-priority imperative for any national-level chamber of commerce.

CCI India's vision is to serve as a bridge between government intent and industry execution translating policy into action, connecting investors with opportunities, enabling startups to scale, and ensuring India's business community is prepared to compete at the global frontier. This Knowledge Paper is the first step in formalising that partnership.

This document is intended for Union Ministers, Secretaries to the Government of India, NITI Aayog, senior bureaucrats, industry leaders, investors, development finance institutions, and international organisations seeking to understand and engage with India's commerce and industry ecosystem at the highest strategic level.

Chamber of Commerce and Industry (CCI India)

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About CCI India

CCI India (The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India) is a premier national business chamber dedicated to fostering economic growth, industry development, entrepreneurship, innovation, and investment promotion across India. As the voice of Indian business and industry, CCI India serves as a bridge between government, industry, startups, academia, investors, and civil society, facilitating meaningful collaboration for nation-building and sustainable development.

Through policy advocacy, business facilitation, research, stakeholder engagement, capacity building, and strategic partnerships, CCI India works to create an enabling environment for enterprises of all sizes. The Chamber actively supports key national initiatives such as Startup India, Make in India, Digital India, Atmanirbhar Bharat, Skill India, and Viksit Bharat 2047 by connecting innovative enterprises with government opportunities and promoting inclusive economic development.

CCI India operates through sector-specific councils, industry forums, knowledge platforms, and state-level engagements that address emerging opportunities and challenges across sectors including manufacturing, agriculture, technology, healthcare, education, infrastructure, sustainability, MSMEs, and startups. The Chamber regularly organizes policy dialogues, investment summits, business delegations, workshops, conferences, and knowledge-sharing initiatives to strengthen India's economic ecosystem.

With a strong commitment to innovation, entrepreneurship, and public-private collaboration, CCI India strives to empower enterprises, facilitate investment, enhance competitiveness, and contribute to India's journey toward becoming a globally competitive and economically resilient nation. Its role as a knowledge partner and industry catalyst enables ministries, departments, state governments, startups, and businesses to collaborate effectively in achieving national development objectives.

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1: Introduction to the Ministry

The Ministry of Commerce and Industry (MoCI) is the nodal institution of the Government of India responsible for formulating and implementing the country's foreign trade policy, industrial policy framework, investment promotion architecture, and intellectual property regime. It exercises oversight over two principal departments the Department of Commerce (DoC) and the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) 1along with a constellation of attached offices, statutory bodies, autonomous institutions, and export promotion councils.

Constitutional and Legal Mandate

Under the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution, trade and commerce are entries listed under the Concurrent List (Entry 33) and the Union List (Entry 41 and 42), granting Parliament overriding legislative authority over inter-state trade, import-export policy, and tariff structures. MoCI draws its operational mandate from the Foreign Trade (Development and Regulation) Act, 1992 (FTDR Act), the Special Economic Zones Act, 2005, the Industries (Development and Regulation) Act, 1951, the Trade Marks Act, 1999, the Patents Act, 1970, the Copyright Act, 1957, and the Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999, among others.

This multi-statute mandate reflects the Ministry's extraordinary breadth: it is simultaneously responsible for regulating India's external economic relations, protecting domestic industry's competitive interests, fostering innovation through IP frameworks, and enabling industrial development through policy incentives and infrastructure. Few institutions in the Government of India span this range of economic governance.

Governance Architecture

MoCI is headed by the Union Minister of Commerce and Industry, supported by a Minister of State. The administrative machinery is led by the Commerce Secretary (DoC) and the DPIIT Secretary, who report to the Minister. The Ministry operates through a dual-department model, each with distinct policy mandates but shared strategic objectives around economic growth, export promotion, and investment facilitation.

National Significance

- **Export Engine:** India's merchandise and services exports combined crossed USD 770 billion in FY2024-25. MoCI's Foreign Trade Policy (FTP) 2023 sets the architecture for India's trade ambition establishing export targets, incentive structures, and facilitation mechanisms. Commerce is not merely a sectoral concern; it is a primary driver of employment, foreign exchange, and geopolitical leverage. Every major export hub from Tirupur textiles to Surat diamonds to Hyderabad pharma operates within a regulatory and policy ecosystem created by MoCI.

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- **Industrial Transformation:** Through DPIIT, the Ministry has architected India's most ambitious industrial transformation in decades. The Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme across 14 sectors with a combined outlay of ₹1.97 lakh crore represents the most significant industrial policy intervention since liberalisation. MoCI's industrial corridor programme, SEZ framework, and National Industrial and Manufacturing Zones (NIMZs) together define the spatial geography of India's manufacturing future.
- **Startup and Innovation Leadership:** The Startup India initiative, anchored within DPIIT, has created the world's third-largest startup ecosystem with over 1,57,000 DPIIT-recognised startups as of 2026. The Ministry's role in shaping the regulatory environment through self-certification, regulatory sandboxes, IP fast-tracking, and fund-of-funds creation positions MoCI as the primary government enabler of India's innovation economy.
- **Investment Facilitation Gateway:** Invest India, an agency under MoCI/DPIIT, serves as India's national investment promotion and facilitation agency. It provides end-to-end investor support, including regulatory guidance, state-level coordination, and sector-specific advisory. MoCI's role in liberalising the FDI policy progressively opening sectors from defence to insurance to retail has made India one of the most attractive investment destinations globally.

2: Historical Timeline of the Ministry

The Ministry of Commerce and Industry's evolution mirrors India's own economic transformation from a command-economy-era regulator of trade and industry to a modern facilitator of global commerce, investment, and innovation. Understanding this institutional journey is essential for contextualising the Ministry's current priorities, structural strengths, and strategic gaps.

Key Milestones in Institutional Evolution

Period	Milestone & Strategic Significance
1947–1950	Establishment of the Ministry of Commerce as part of the early administrative framework of independent India. Initial mandate focused on import controls and industrial licensing to protect nascent domestic industries.
1956	Industrial Policy Resolution, 1956 a landmark document that classified industries into public sector reservations, mixed economy sectors, and private enterprise zones, shaping MoCI's regulatory role for decades.
1970	Patents Act, 1970 enacted a foundational piece of IP legislation that shaped India's pharmaceutical and technology sectors for 35 years. India adopted a process-patent-only model, enabling generic drug manufacturing.
1991	Economic liberalisation MoCI's mandate fundamentally transformed. Industrial licensing abolished for most sectors; trade liberalisation accelerated. The Ministry shifted from regulator to facilitator.

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